



Gift agreement

Donor: Grant Larceny. Recipient: The Meridian Museum of Art & World Cultures.

1. Naming: The institution shall be renamed The Grant Larceny Meridian Museum.
2. Governance: The donor shall retain approval rights over future acquisitions.
3. Management: Artie Ficial shall tender his resignation within sixty days of acceptance.

Artie - confirm acceptance before the unveiling. G.L.

DRAFT - NOT EXECUTED



Shipping manifest / 1988

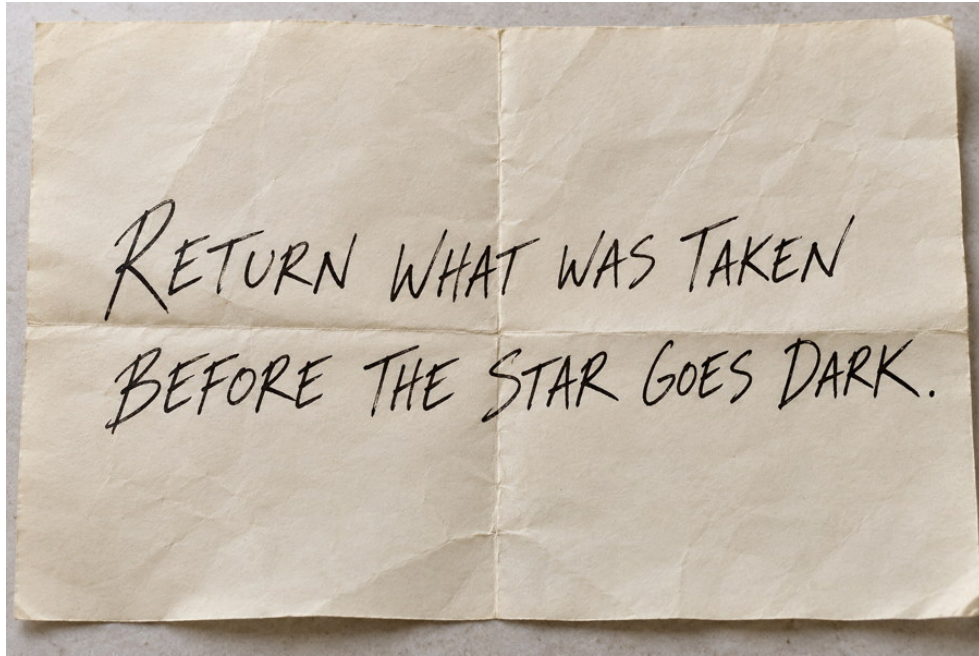
Consignment	Isfahan Star Bowl
Routing	Geneva freeport / onward transfer
Shipper	Northstar Holdings
Declared owner	REDACTED
Export file	Not attached

Keep with accession papers. Do not substitute exhibition label for ownership file.

OWNER REDACTED



A warning left behind



*RETURN WHAT WAS TAKEN BEFORE THE
STAR GOES DARK.*

NO SIGNATURE



GRANT'S NIGHT OF GLORY

Advance program: preparation walkthrough 6:20–6:28.
Private glass unwrapped 6:40; cover sealed 6:44. Pour 6:46;
toast 6:49.

Grant Larceny will announce the naming agreement after his
private toast.

Advance proof / planned program, not a record of attendance.

HOLD FOR 9:00 PM



Treatment finding

Object	Isfahan Star Bowl
Examiner	Chip Patina
6:37 finding	Mount hairline crack
Requested action	Seal display alcove immediately

Earlier adhesive finding also disputed by donor. Safety takes priority.

REVIEW REQUIRED



Donor agreement / margin copy

The proposed permanent gift remains subject to outstanding provenance review. An accession does not remove competing ownership claims.

Permanent title does not cure disputed title. S.V.

ORIGINAL OPINION



Auction result

Lot	Private collection acquisition
Successful bidder	Anonymous / through Hugh Bidder
Competing bidder	Grant Larceny
Result	Sold to proxy buyer

E.M. beat G.L. through a proxy. He will never forgive this.

LOT CIRCLED FOR REVIEW



Vincent Van Faux

Early student work

Loan courtesy of Grant Larceny

Treasures of the World / Gallery label

NO. This does not belong in the show.

PROOF - NOT APPROVED



Education reallocation

Program	Proposed change
School tours	REDUCE
Community programs	REDUCE
Private donor lounge	INCREASE
VIP entrance	INCREASE

Anne E. Dote has not approved these cuts.

DONOR CONDITIONS



Donor Salon camera

Requested by	Grant Larceny
Action	Disconnect salon camera
Start	6:29 PM
Reason	Private donor meetings
Authorized by	Barb Dwyer
Disconnected by	Staff technician

Deliberate disconnection. Not a technical fault.

OFFLINE BY REQUEST



Donation entry / 1989

Donor	Grant Larceny
Accession approval	Anya Tique
Object status	Accepted into collection
Export papers	Promised - not yet received

File remains incomplete.

ARCHIVE EXTRACT



Closing reveal / concept



Original stage concept: Dada DiCapo.

Printed gala credit: The Larceny Foundation.

The sketch predates the donor's program credit.



The Velvet Widow

Lot 73 Sealed poison bottle from the Eleanor
Vale murder case, 1891

Buyer Grant Larceny

**Proposed
exhibition** The Art of Murder

Buyer's condition of purchase: retain original contents. Do
not substitute an empty bottle or replica.

COLLECTION TRANSFER / ORIGINAL CONTENTS RETAINED



The conservator's objection

The bottle is labeled CYANIDE. Display an empty replica. I object to Grant's demand that the original poison remain in the exhibition centerpiece.

Grant has requested a final condition inspection before the unveiling. One sealed bottle will be brought from the locked cupboard to the visitor-side preparation shelf during the 6:20–6:28 walkthrough, then locked away again. No other poison objects will be brought out.

The west counter handles returns through a paper slot. Visitors enter from the east doorway.

EXHIBITION APPROVAL WITHHELD



Canceled program cue

6:37 Display safety alert received

6:48 cue CANCELED / emergency takes priority

Curtain position Closed at 6:38 / safety override

Display mounting alert received 6:37. Alcove closed at 6:38 pending inspection. Planned 6:48 closure canceled.

Gallery outside the alcove remains open. No change to private service.

LIGHTING JOB LOG / NOT SECURITY LOG



Grant Larceny's toast

6:40 / Remove the blue wrapping from Grant's glass.

6:44 / Fit the clear cover and apply its numbered seal.

6:46 / Check and open the seal. Pour the shared punch.

6:49 / Grant's private toast. Use the same glass throughout.

DONOR SALON DELIVERY



The gift came with conditions

DRAFT GIFT AGREEMENT / NOT SIGNED

1. Museum name

The Grant Larceny Meridian Museum

2. Collection decisions

Grant may veto future acquisitions

3. Museum director

Artie Ficial must resign within sixty days

Donor signature: _____

Grant Larceny has died at the gala after his private toast. His proposed gift agreement is still unsigned. These are the terms he intended to announce tonight.



An empty bottle in preparation



Object	The Velvet Widow poison bottle / acquisition lot 73
Label	CYANIDE / POISON
Found	Empty; original paper seal broken

I found the newly acquired poison bottle empty after the preparation-room tour. Its paper seal was broken. I locked the room and retained the bottle for examination. It had been brought out for the condition inspection of Grant's proposed exhibition centerpiece. Signed: Collections Assistant.



What happened to Grant's glass



6:39 / Still wrapped; seal intact



6:40 / Unwrapped; glass left unattended



6:44 / Covered; red seal applied



6:46 / Seal opened; punch poured

Initial lab finding

Cyanide inside Grant's glass

Shared punch and food

No cyanide detected

These are my setup photos. I stayed with the wrapped glass until 6:40. From 6:40 to 6:44, I was away from the table. After sealing the cover at 6:44, I watched it until I opened it to pour. I then watched Grant's glass until his 6:49 toast. The same glass was used throughout. Signed: Service Manager.



When the bottle was accessible



Recovered bottle / photographed after the tour

6:20 / room opens	Bottle full; original paper seal intact
6:28 / room closes	Bottle empty; cupboard locked
Other poison objects	No other bottles brought out or given to guests

The bottle was kept locked away before the tour. It was put on the visitor-side shelf when the room opened and locked away again at closing. Nobody obtained it outside those eight minutes. The laboratory matched material remaining in the bottle to residue inside Grant's glass.



Two different ways to approach preparation



WEST / return counter

Papers pass through a small slot

EAST / visitor doorway

Guests can enter and reach the shelf

The west return counter is outside a solid wall. Its small slot passes papers and support sleeves, not people. Staff did not pass the bottle or its contents through it. The east doorway is the only guest entrance to the shelves.



The glass, not the punch

Grant's glass / inside
CYANIDE DETECTED

Shared punch pitcher
NO CYANIDE DETECTED

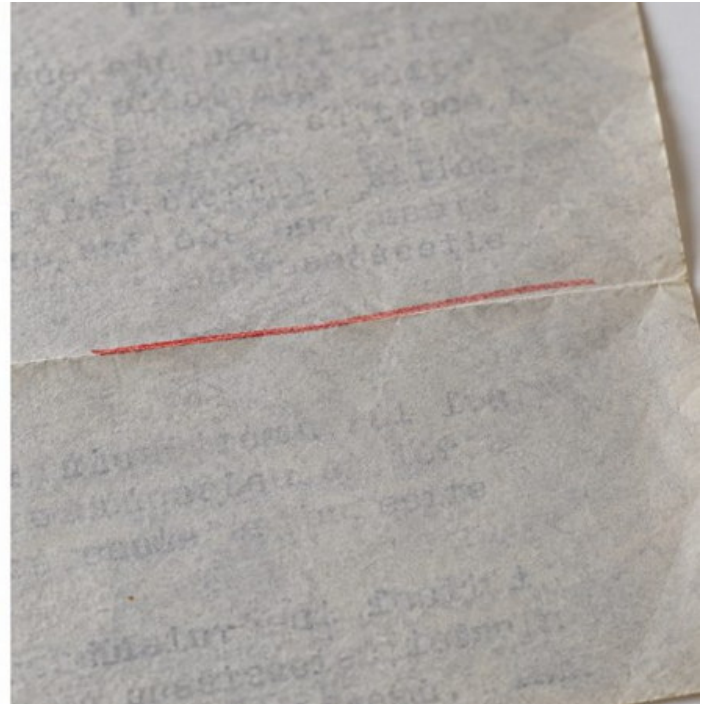
Food samples
NO CYANIDE DETECTED

Acquired poison bottle
MIXTURE MATCHES GLASS RESIDUE

Cyanide was found on the inside of Grant's glass. Samples of the shared punch and food were clear. Material remaining in the acquired poison bottle matches the residue in the glass. The lab result identifies the poisoned object; the caterer's record establishes how it was handled.



Two details from the museum's records



Blue protective wrapping

Logo sticker across a closed seam

Blue cloth placemat

Logo embroidered into fabric

Raised RECEIVED stamp

First used at 6:45

The museum-logo sticker bridged the sealed plastic wrapping. The placemat's logo was sewn into cloth. They are different objects. The receiving desk first used its raised RECEIVED stamp at 6:45. Earlier working copies had flat red-pencil corrections, not that stamp.
